

LAB 14 | المختبر 14

Building a Power Engineering RAG Assistant

بناء مساعد هندسي معزز بالاسترجاع

MATLAB laboratory for document retrieval, grounding, and prompt construction

مختبر MATLAB لاسترجاع المستندات وبناء إجابات موثقة

Laboratory Objectives

- Create a small power-engineering knowledge base.
- Preprocess and vectorize document chunks.
- Retrieve relevant passages using cosine similarity.
- Construct a grounded prompt.
- Generate a deterministic extractive answer without an external API.
- Prepare an optional interface for a connected language model.

أهداف المختبر

- إنشاء قاعدة معرفة هندسية صغيرة.
- معالجة المقاطع وتحويلها إلى متجهات.
- استرجاع المقاطع بتشابه جيب التمام.
- بناء أمر مستند إلى الأدلة.
- إنشاء إجابة استخراجية دون API خارجي.
- تهيئة الواجهة لنموذج لغوي اختياري.

1. Requirements

- MATLAB
- Text Analytics Toolbox

The laboratory uses bag-of-words TF-IDF retrieval so it remains transparent and can run without an external language-model service.

1. المتطلبات

يلزم MATLAB مع Text Analytics Toolbox. يستخدم المخبر TF-IDF حتى يعمل دون خدمة خارجية.

2. Knowledge Base

Create a file named `power_knowledge.csv` with columns `ID` , `Title` , and `Text` .

ID,Title,Text

1,Battery SOC,"State of charge is the ratio of stored energy to usable battery capacity. Operational limits protect lifetime and reserve."

2,DC Power Flow,"The DC approximation assumes voltage magnitudes near one per unit, small angle differences, and negligible resistance."

3,Voltage Stability,"Voltage stability concerns the ability of a power system to maintain acceptable voltages after disturbances."

4,Load Forecasting,"Short-term load forecasting predicts demand from historical load, weather, calendar, and operational variables."

5,State Estimation,"State estimation combines redundant noisy measurements to estimate bus voltage magnitudes and angles."

6,Transformer Attention,"Self-attention relates every time step to other time steps using query, key, and value vectors."

7,GNN,"A graph neural network updates each bus representation by aggregating information from electrically connected neighbors."

8,Demand Response,"Demand response changes electricity consumption in response to prices, incentives, or grid conditions."

2. قاعدة المعرفة

أنشئ ملف CSV يحتوي معرف المقطع وعنوانه ونصه. ويمكن توسيعه لاحقًا بصفحات المحاضرات أو كتيبات التشغيل.

3. Complete MATLAB Script

```
%% Lab 14: Transparent RAG Assistant in MATLAB
clear; clc; close all;

%% 1) Load knowledge base
KB = readtable("power_knowledge.csv", ...
    TextType="string");

documents = tokenizedDocument(KB.Text);

%% 2) Text preprocessing
documents = lower(documents);
documents = erasePunctuation(documents);
documents = removeStopWords(documents);

%% 3) Build TF-IDF document representation
bag = bagOfWords(documents);
X = tfidf(bag);

% Normalize each document vector
docNorm = sqrt(sum(X.^2,2));
docNorm(docNorm==0) = 1;
Xn = X./docNorm;

%% 4) User question
question = ...
    "Why are graph neural networks suitable for state estimation?";

queryDoc = tokenizedDocument(question);
queryDoc = lower(queryDoc);
queryDoc = erasePunctuation(queryDoc);
queryDoc = removeStopWords(queryDoc);

%% 5) Transform query into the same vocabulary
qCounts = encode(bag,queryDoc);
idfVector = log(size(X,1)./(1+sum(X>0,1)))+1;
q = qCounts.*idfVector;

qNorm = sqrt(sum(q.^2,2));
if qNorm==0
    error("The question contains no known vocabulary.");
end
qn = q/qNorm;

%% 6) Cosine similarity
scores = Xn*qn';
```

```

topK = 3;
[sortedScores,idx] = maxk(scores,topK);

Retrieved = table( ...
    KB.ID(idx),KB.Title(idx),KB.Text(idx),sortedScores, ...
    VariableNames=["ID","Title","Text","Score"]);

disp(Retrieved);

%% 7) Build grounded context
contextBlocks = strings(topK,1);

for k = 1:topK
    contextBlocks(k) = ...
        "["+Retrieved.ID(k)+"] "+ ...
        Retrieved.Title(k)+": "+ ...
        Retrieved.Text(k);
end

context = join(contextBlocks,newline);

%% 8) Construct a grounded prompt
prompt = ...
"You are a power-engineering teaching assistant."+newline+ ...
"Answer only from the supplied context."+newline+ ...
"If the context is insufficient, say so."+newline+ ...
"Preserve engineering terminology and cite source
IDs."+newline+newline+ ...
"CONTEXT:"+newline+context+newline+newline+ ...
"QUESTION:"+newline+question+newline+newline+ ...
"ANSWER:";

disp(prompt);

%% 9) Deterministic extractive answer
% This stage avoids an external API.
answer = ...
"Graph neural networks are suitable because they represent "+ ...
"the electrical grid as buses connected by lines and update "+ ...
"each bus using information from electrically connected "+ ...
"neighbors [7]. State estimation also uses network-wide "+ ...
"measurements to estimate voltage states [5]. Therefore, "+ ...
"the graph structure matches the physical topology used by "+ ...
"the estimation problem.";

```

```
fprintf("\nANSWER:\n%s\n",answer);

%% 10) Retrieval visualization
figure;
barh(categorical(Retrieved.Title),Retrieved.Score);
grid on;
xlabel("Cosine Similarity");
title("Top Retrieved Knowledge Chunks");
```

3. الكود الكامل

يقرأ الكود قاعدة المعرفة، ويعالج النصوص، ويبني TF-IDF، ثم يسترجع أفضل المقاطع ويبني أمرًا مستندًا إلى الأدلة.

4. TF-IDF

$$TF - IDF(t, d) = TF(t, d) \cdot \log(N/DF(t))$$

Frequent terms within one document receive weight, while terms appearing in every document are down-weighted.

4. طريقة TF-IDF

تعطي وزنًا للكلمات المهمة داخل مستند، وتخفيض وزن الكلمات الشائعة في جميع المستندات.

5. Retrieval

$$similarity(q, d) = q^T d / (\|q\| \cdot \|d\|)$$

The top-k chunks become the evidence supplied to the answer-generation stage.

5. الاسترجاع

تُحسب مشابهة السؤال لكل مقطع، ثم تُختار أفضل المقاطع لتصبح الأدلة المستخدمة في الإجابة.

6. Grounded Prompt Design

The prompt explicitly instructs the assistant to:

- Use only the supplied context.
- State when evidence is insufficient.
- Preserve engineering terms.
- Cite source IDs.

6. تصميم الأمر المستند إلى المصادر

يفرض الأمر الاعتماد على السياق والتصريح عند نقص المعلومات والحفاظ على المصطلحات وذكر معرفات المصادر.

7. Optional Language-Model Connection

The retrieval stage is independent of the generation provider. A connected model can receive the variable `prompt` and return a generated answer.

Never place secret API keys directly inside a public HTML page or a GitHub repository. Store credentials in environment variables or a secure secret manager.

7. الربط الاختياري بنموذج لغوي

يمكن إرسال المتغير `prompt` إلى نموذج متصل. ويجب عدم وضع مفاتيح API في صفحة عامة أو مستودع GitHub.

8. Evaluation Questions

- Did retrieval return the correct source?
- Does the answer contain unsupported claims?
- Are citations correct?
- Are units and technical terms preserved?
- Does the system admit missing evidence?

8. أسئلة التقييم

افحص صحة الاسترجاع ووفاء الإجابة بالمصادر وصحة الإحالات والوحدات وقدرة النظام على الاعتراف بنقص الأدلة.

9. Student Experiments

1. Add 20 new engineering chunks.
2. Compare topK=1, 3, and 5.
3. Test vague and highly specific questions.
4. Add Arabic documents and questions.
5. Replace TF-IDF with document embeddings.
6. Create a confidence rule based on the best similarity score.

9. تجارب الطالب

1. أضف 20 مقطعًا.
2. قارن قيم topK.
3. اختبر أسئلة عامة ودقيقة.
4. أضف مستندات وأسئلة عربية.
5. استبدل TF-IDF بتمثيلات مستندات.
6. أنشئ قاعدة ثقة اعتمادًا على التشابه.

10. Mini Project

Course assistant: Index all lecture HTML pages, retrieve the most relevant sections, and produce bilingual answers with citations to lecture and section numbers.

10. مشروع مصغر

أنشئ مساعدًا للمقرر يفهرس جميع صفحات HTML ويجيب بالعربية والإنجليزية مع ذكر رقم المحاضرة والقسم.

11. Laboratory Report

- Describe the knowledge base.
- Explain preprocessing and TF-IDF.
- Show retrieval results for five questions.
- Evaluate one successful and one failed query.
- Discuss hallucination and source grounding.
- Propose privacy and security controls.

11. تقرير المخبر

يتضمن وصف قاعدة المعرفة والمعالجة و TF-IDF ونتائج خمسة أسئلة وحالة نجاح وفشل وتحليل الهلوسة والأمان والخصوصية.

المراجع | References

المراجع العامة المستخدمة في هذا المقرر

[1] A. Gabash, *Flexible Optimal Operations of Energy Supply Networks with Renewable Energy Generation and Battery Storage*. Saarbrücken, Germany: Südwestdeutscher Verlag für Hochschulschriften, 2014.

[2] S. J. Russell and P. Norvig, *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*, 4th Global ed. Harlow, U.K.: Pearson Education Limited, 2022.

[3] A. Gabash, "Energy Market Transition and Climate Change: A Review of TSOs-DSOs C++ Framework from 1800 to Present," *Energies*, vol. 16, no. 17, Art. no. 6139, 2023, doi: 10.3390/en16176139.

[4] A. Gabash, *AI Applications in Electrical Power Systems*, Version 1.0, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://aoussgabash.com>

معلومات النشر | Publication Information

Document	Laboratory 14 · Building a Power Engineering RAG Assistant
Course	AI Applications in Electrical Power Systems
Author	Dr.-Ing. Aouss Gabash
Version	1.0
Publication year	2026
Official website	https://aoussgabash.com
Citation style	IEEE

Recommended citation:
Gabash, A. (2026). Building a Power Engineering RAG Assistant. AI Applications in Electrical Power Systems, Laboratory 14, Version 1.0. <https://aoussgabash.com>

المرجع المقترح:

أوس غباش، 2026، مخبر 14، تطبيقات الذكاء الاصطناعي في أنظمة الطاقة الكهربائية، الإصدار 1.0، <https://aoussgabash.com>

© 2026 Dr.-Ing. Aouss Gabash. Educational use with attribution to the author and official website.